

English – Tetum glossary

Terms used across the SORT IT training materials, the website and the platform.

Reviewed terminology

Every term below was checked by a Tetum-speaking colleague in August 2026. This glossary is the **single source of truth** — the training materials, the website and the platform all draw their Tetum from this list, so a correction made here reaches everything.

Research and the programme

English	Tetum
Research	Peskiza
Operational research	Peskiza operasionál
Data analysis	Analiza dados
Result	Rezultadu
Research question agreed	Pergunta peskiza konkorda ona
Protocol completed	Protokolu kompletu
Ethics approval obtained	Aprovasaun etika simu ona
Data collection completed	Rekolla dados kompletu
Analysis completed	Analiza kompletu
Draft manuscript completed	Esbosu manuscript kompletu
Submitted to journal	Submete ba revista
Published	Publika ona
Report	Relatóriu
Recommendation	Rekomendasaun
Conclusion	Konkluziun
Questionnaire	Kestionáriu
Sample	Amostra

Data and analysis

English	Tetum
Data / dataset	Dados
Variable	Variavel
Category / group	Kategoria / grupu
Number	Numeru
Count	Konta

English	Tetum
Total	Totál
Percentage	Pursentu
Numerator	Numeradór
Denominator	Denominadór
Mean / average	mean (rata-rata)
Median	valór klaran
Range	Intervalu
Typical, usual	Baibain
Middle	Klaran
High / low	Aas / kraik
Order / sequence	ordem, sekuensia

Presenting results

English	Tetum
Table	Tabela
Graph / chart	Grafiku
Bar chart	Grafiku barra
Column	Koluna
Row	Liña
Line	Liña
Title	Títulu
Note / footnote	Nota
Picture / image	Imajen
Meaning	Signifikadu

Checking and cleaning data

English	Tetum
Clean (data)	Hamoos dados
Check, verify	Verifika
Mistake / error	Sala
Duplicate	Duplika
Empty / blank	Mamuk
Missing / not there	La iha
Change	Muda
Quality	Kualidade

Working in Excel

English	Tetum
Formula	Fórmula
Cell	cel
Sheet	Fólia
Sort	Ordena
Copy	Kopia
Save	Rai

People, places and patients

English	Tetum
Patient	Pasiente
Sex	Seksu (feto / mane)
Age	Idade
Municipality	Munisípiu
Health facility	Fasilidade saúde
Disease / illness	Moras
Tuberculosis	Moras TB / tuberkuloze
Treatment	Tratamentu
Distance	Distánsia

Outcomes

English	Tetum
Success	Susesu
Died	Mate
Lost / disappeared	Lakon

Explaining and discussing

English	Tetum
Explain	Esplika
Explain simply	Esplika simples
Compare	Kompara
Compare with	Kompara ho
Increase / decrease	Aumenta / hamenus
Because of	Tanba
Who is responsible	Se mak responsavel

English	Tetum
Must change	Presiza muda
Maybe wrong	Karik sala
Far / near	Dook / besik
Stand up	Hamriik
Group together	Grupu hamutuk

Other terms

English	Tetum
To clean (data)	Atu hamoos dadus

Where a term is normally said in English or Portuguese even when speaking Tetum — for example **statistically significant** — it has been left in English deliberately. Forcing a translation nobody uses is worse than leaving it.